

JOSÉ MARÍA ZAPATERO SANTOS

PACKAGING AND MANUFACTURING EXCELLENCE MANAGER

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 Valladolid (Spain)

 29 April 1995

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Experienced professional in the brewing industry, with a comprehensive background on food manufacturing operations, ranging from recipe development across multiple packaging formats (NPD) to the full management of large-scale operations. Proven ability in building and leading cross-functional teams, driving the achievement of goals aligned with strategic objectives. My expertise includes process optimization (LSSBB), implementation of quality and food safety standards, and the leadership of innovation projects.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Packaging and Manufacturing Excellence Manager, Royal Swinkels | April 2025 - Ongoing (Mariel, Cuba)

- In charge of the Packaging Department, overseeing two production lines (PET and Kegs) and a team of 28 Operators, 4 Supervisors, 1 Technician and 1 Operations Manager. Also responsible for implementing GMPs (Good Manufacturing Practices) across site.
- Increased production efficiency by 21% within the first 4 months through the implementation of operational standards, autonomous maintenance programs, and effective personal training, contributing to overall performance improvement in the area.
- Established Workplace Health & Safety and Food Safety as operational priorities, successfully completing the development of the HACCP system within the department.

Production Manager, Royal Swinkels | August 2024 - April 2025 (Mariel, Cuba)

- Supervised the Brewing, Packaging, Quality and Production Planning teams, leading a workforce of 90 employees.
- Developed the Production Planning Department, which had not previously existed, enabling the creation of production plans based on sales forecasts and aligned through the S&OP process.
- Successfully transitioned all production operations to a continuous 24/7 operations model.

Brewing Manager, Royal Swinkels | September 2022 - August 2024 (Mariel, Cuba)

- Responsible for all operations from raw material intake through to the filtered beer cellar.
- Successfully managed the plant start-up, recruiting and training a team of 36 Operators, 4 Supervisors and 1 Technician, achieving 60% area capacity within the first 5 months of operations.
- Designed a personnel development plan that enabled the training of local leaders, resulting in the area now being fully managed by 100% national talents.
- Led the New Product Development (NPD) process for the creation of a malt-based soft drink, recognized by consumers as the best-tasting product on the market for this category, strengthening the company's portfolio.

Craft Brewer, Greene King | October 2020 - August 2022 (Bury Saint Edmunds, United Kingdom)

- Led the New Product Development (NPD) team at the brewery, consisting of two people, responsible for all new recipes as well as participating in process improvements from a quality, cost, or efficiency standpoint.
- Successfully developed 4 beers in can, bottle and keg formats, as part of a new product line called "Premium Beers". This was a project with a budget of over £6 million, aimed at revitalizing the company's portfolio and attracting younger customers. Flint Eye and Level Head, the two flagship products, were awarded Bronze and Gold medals respectively at the World Beer Awards, achieving mass distribution in thousands of on-trade and off-trade outlets across the UK.
- Responsible for the annual development of 6 seasonal beers, some in collaboration with local craft breweries.

PROFESSIONAL AND ACADEMIC COURSES

- Leading with Finance**, Harvard Business School, July 2026.
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt**, Global Six Sigma Institute, April 2026.
- NC-ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management Systems**, CDGC Cuba, July 2025.
- Managing Safely**, IOSH, May 2022.
- Brewing Science and Practice MSc** University of Nottingham, 2019-2020.
- Master in Business Administration (MBA)**, Universidad Internacional de la Rioja, 2018-2019.
- Biotechnology BSc**, Universidad de León, Southeast Missouri State University, 2013-2018.

KEY SKILLS

- Inclusive Leadership and Talent Development: Proven ability to build, motivate and develop cross-functional and multicultural teams, fostering the growth of local talent and ensuring operational sustainability.*
- Operational Excellence and Continuous Improvement: Experienced in implementing standardized work systems, enhancing efficiency, and promoting a culture of food and workplace safety (HACCP, GMPs).*
- Results Orientation and Sustainability: Focused on efficiency, quality, and safety KPIs, with a strategic vision aligned with organizational and sustainability objectives.*
- End-to-End Plant Management: Knowledge and experience in production, planning, quality, internal logistics and start-up of new lines and products.*
- Product Development Innovation: Track record in NPD, successfully adapting portfolios to new consumer demands and market trends with demonstrated commercial success and industry recognition.*

LANGUAGES

- SPANISH (native)
- ENGLISH (bilingual)